

Q Upgrading to faster RAM

I have system having configuration

- Intel Core 2 Duo E4400 2.0GHz
- Intel 945GCPE motherboard
- 512 MB DDR2 667MHz RAM
- 80 GB HDD

I wanted to know that how much memory can I extend on this motherboard and of what speed? Is 800 MHz DDR2 compatible with this motherboard. I want to extend up to 4 GB. What will be the approximate cost?

Pranav Prajapati
Gujarat

A You should be able to use DDR2 800MHz RAM but, your system will only run it at 667MHz. The cost of DDR2 RAM is around ₹4,500 for two sticks of 2 GB each. An upgrade to 2GB will be more than sufficient for your configuration though. Any more and you won't see a difference in performance in most applications.

Q Need config for high-end rendering rig

I've been reading Digit for the past 8 months and love everything about it. Digit helped me in many ways for better computing.

I need to buy a computer and my budget is around \$3000. The main purpose of the computer would be working on high-end software such as Maya. I will be rendering huge files on it and also for editing HD videos. So one of my friend said that I should go in for a Mac but the thing is the cost of the configuration would cost me in excess of \$8000. That's not affordable and not being able to play the games I want to, is another disadvantage.

So please suggest me a good PC configuration in and around \$3000 which can render huge files in Maya, edit HD videos without any holdups and also let me play latest games. Can you also tell me whether AMD or Intel is better?

Samuel Chadwick

A Here's a configuration to consider

- Intel Core i7 960
- ASUS Rampage II Gene
- Corsair Value RAM - 2 GB x 6

- Dell Ultrasharp U2711
- ZOTAC GeForce GTX470
- 2 x 2TB Seagate Barracuda
- Corsair HX620
- Logitech MX518
- Cooler Master 690 II

I'm emphasizing more on the components which will help you the most with your work and gaming. I would recommend installing Windows 7 64-bit so that you can use all of that memory. We've also recommended the Dell U2711 - a great 27-inch display with great colours and a massive resolution which will help tons while working on HD content. The processor and RAM will help you render out huge scenes with relative ease and the GTX470 although an overkill for 3d modelling, will do well in games. Most often, certain models in certain price ranges are better than their competitors. It's unfair to say that AMD is better than Intel, or vice-versa.

Q Upgrading system, have doubts

I need your expert advice on my new PC configuration which I'm assembling. I have shortlisted the following specifications:

- Processor: AMD Phenom II x6 1055T
- Motherboard: Gigabyte 890GPA-UD3H
- RAM: 2 x 2GB DDR3 1333MHz Gskill/ Corsair performance RAM
- Harddisk: Seagate Barracuda 7200.12 1TB or WD Green 1TB
- Optical drive: LG/Samsung 22x/24x SATA DVD writer
- Cabinet (w/o SMPS) : Coolermaster 690 or 690 II plus or
- Simple USB Keyboard (from Logitech or Microsoft)
- Logitech MX518 Gaming Mouse

I'll be using my present monitor which is Samsung Syncmaster 933SN and will add an ATI HD5770 based card for gaming. My queries are as follows:

1. Will my present powersupply VIP-500W be enough for the above configuration?
2. Is the above configuration good enough to play recent games at decent

resolutions?

3. What may be the expected cost of the whole setup?

Last but not the least, I would like to know what may be the market cost of Acer eMachine E725 laptop (with added 1GB RAM to make upto 2GB or more).

Umesh Rao

A The 500W PSU should be sufficient for your configuration. The configura-



tion should be good enough to play games at resolutions of around 1680x1050.

The approximate cost of your configuration should be close to ₹40,000 including the graphics solution. The price of the Acer eMachines e725 laptop should be around ₹23,000. Note that the laptop maybe available in different configurations and prices may differ accordingly.

Q Need a voice amplifier

I am a teacher by profession and recently advised not to over strain my voice due to some throat problems.

For this I am looking for some portable voice amplifier products that could be used in classrooms. I am a regular reader of Digit but can't remember of reading reviews of such articles in the magazine. I also searched net but was confused about the options there.

Can you please help me in this regard? I badly need your guidance. It needs to be Portable (preferably a belt version) with good amplification and preferably powered by AA rechargeable batteries. My budget is around ₹3000.

Sudipta Sarkar